

Annual Disaster Recovery (DR) Exercise Results

DISASTER RECOVERY EXERCISE: POST-DRILL REPORT

Exercise Type: Full Region Failover (Unannounced) Simulated Scenario: Category 5 Hurricane striking the US-East-1 data center. Drill Date: August 15, 2026 Coordinator: Julian Sterling, VP of Infrastructure

Objective: To validate the Recovery Time Objective (RTO) of 4 hours and Recovery Point Objective (RPO) of 15 minutes for the core logistics routing engine, simulating a complete loss of the primary AWS region.

Execution Timeline: - 02:00 UTC: Simulated disaster initiated. Network routes to US-East-1 null-holed. - 02:05 UTC: Monitoring systems triggered P1 alerts. DR Team assembled on the primary bridge. - 02:15 UTC: Cross-region read replicas in US-West-2 promoted to primary write nodes. - 02:45 UTC: Stateless application containers spun up in US-West-2 via automated Terraform scripts. - 03:10 UTC: Global DNS routing updated via Route53 to direct customer traffic to the secondary region. - 03:30 UTC: System validation complete. Core services restored.

Results against Objectives: - Achieved RTO: 1 hour 30 minutes (Target: 4 hours) - PASS - Achieved RPO: 4 minutes of data loss (Target: 15 minutes) - PASS

Identified Gaps: While the core database and application layers failed over flawlessly, the legacy batch-processing workers (used for end-of-day invoice generation) failed to initialize. The Amazon Machine Images (AMIs) referenced in the DR provisioning scripts for these workers were deprecated and unavailable in the US-West-2 region.

Action Items: Update the AMI replication policy to ensure all active machine images, including legacy worker nodes, are automatically copied to the secondary region upon creation. Re-test the batch-processing failover by September 10.